



The HVAC Playbook

Five workflows from the 6pm no-heat emergency to the spring maintenance renewal -- built for HVAC techs, service managers, and shop owners.

What's inside

Quote a full system replacement in under 20 minutes from the in-home assessment.

Run a maintenance-plan renewal cadence that hits the spring and fall target dates.

Same-day emergency dispatch that holds the price on a no-heat call.

Post-repair warranty follow-up that lands the next system replacement.

12 months of free updates — every improvement ships to your inbox

5 workflows · 5 copy-paste AI prompts & scripts · AI stack setup · 12 months of free updates

SkillForge AI — 2026 Edition



AI STACK

Your AI Stack — What to Buy, What to Skip

"AI stack" is just a fancy way of saying "the AI tools you pay for." Yours is short. That's the point.

Buy this: one chatbot subscription

Pick one of these. Either is fine. They both do everything in this book.

- ChatGPT Plus (OpenAI) — around \$20/month at the time of writing; check current pricing.
- Claude Pro (Anthropic) — around \$20/month at the time of writing; check current pricing.

That's it. One subscription, about twenty bucks a month. Everything in this playbook — every prompt, every workflow — runs on it.

Why paid instead of free?

The free versions work, but they cut you off when you use them heavily and they're slower during the day. For a business tool you lean on between jobs, the paid tier is worth it. Twenty dollars is less than the profit on a single service call.

Phone or computer? Both.

Install the app on your phone — that's where you'll use it most, standing in a driveway dictating notes. Use the website on your computer for longer writing sessions.

Maybe later: AI phone answering

If missed calls are your biggest leak — and in July and January they are — an AI receptionist service that answers when you can't is the highest-return upgrade after the chatbot. It answers, takes the details, books the appointment, and texts you a summary.

This book doesn't recommend a specific provider, because the market moves fast and pricing changes. When you're ready, shop for one the way you'd shop for any subcontractor: get three options, ask what happens on a call you can't take at 2 PM on a Tuesday, and make sure you can listen to real sample calls before you commit.

Do not buy this on day one. Get comfortable with the chatbot first. Add phone answering later, once you've felt the savings.



AI STACK

Your AI Stack — What to Buy, What to Skip

Skip all of this

- "AI-powered" dispatch software sold to HVAC shops. Your scheduling problem is solved with the chatbot and the system you already have. Don't buy new software to fix a workflow problem.
- AI logo makers, AI website builders, AI business-card designers. Vanity purchases. They don't book jobs.
- Multiple chatbot subscriptions. You need one. ChatGPT and Claude is paying twice for the same thing.
- Anything that claims to "run your Manual J load calculations" or "verify refrigerant charge." Sizing and charge are measured, not guessed.

The stack, summarized

What	Cost	When
One chatbot subscription (ChatGPT Plus or Claude Pro)	~\$20/month	Day one
AI phone answering	Varies — shop around	Later, only if missed calls are your top leak
Everything else	\$0	Skip it

Your total starting cost: about \$20/month. If this book saves you a single hour this month, it has paid for itself several times over.

Set it up once: teach the chatbot your business

Both ChatGPT and Claude let you save "custom instructions" — background info the AI remembers every time. Spend five minutes on this once, and every prompt in this book gets better, because the AI already knows who you are.

Fill this in and paste it into the custom instructions (usually under Settings → Personalization or similar):

I own [YOUR COMPANY NAME], an HVAC business serving [SERVICE AREA]. We do residential heating and cooling: installs, diagnostics, maintenance plans, and emergency service. My customers are homeowners — non-technical. When you write for me: plain language, warm but professional tone, no jargon without explanation. Never invent technical specifications, prices, or timelines I didn't provide. Keep customer-facing writing short — under the word count I specify.



WORKFLOW 01 OF 05

In-Home Full System Quote -- The 20-Minute Build

A two-step prompt that turns the in-home assessment (heat loss calc, ductwork check, prior system age) into a fixed-price replacement quote with the three option tiers.

Estimated time-to-run: 20 minutes per assessment

1*ChatGPT or Claude*

HOW TO INPUT

1. Open the prompt at the kitchen-table review after the assessment.
2. Paste the home square footage, existing system age, and the homeowner budget signal.
3. Paste the prompt below. Replace the placeholders.
4. Use the output as the quote form on the iPad.

PROMPT

You are an HVAC service manager pricing a full system replacement. Below is the in-home assessment. Generate a three-tier quote as a 3-row table (Tier | System | Includes | Price | Best For). Cover, in order: (1) Good -- a single-stage 80% AFUE furnace or 14 SEER AC, single compressor, basic thermostat -- for the budget-anchored homeowner; (2) Better -- a two-stage 95% AFUE furnace or 16 SEER AC, variable-speed blower, smart thermostat -- for the homeowner who already named comfort as a goal; (3) Best -- a modulating 98% AFUE furnace or 18+ SEER inverter AC, zoning, two zones, full warranty -- for the homeowner who asked about long-term utility costs. Numbers, no filler adjectives, no "as needed". Assess notes: [PASTE NOTES].

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 3-tier system-replacement quote with system, includes, price, and best-for column.

Step time estimate: 15 minutes



WORKFLOW 02 OF 05

Diagnostic Report -- The Same-Day Email

A two-step prompt that turns the diagnostic findings into a same-day written report the homeowner can show the spouse, the insurance adjuster, or the second-opinion tech.

Estimated time-to-run: 12 minutes per visit

1*ChatGPT or Claude*

HOW TO INPUT

1. Open the prompt at the truck before driving to the next job.
2. Paste the diagnostic finding (one symptom + one cause + one fix).
3. Paste the prompt below. Replace the placeholders.
4. Send before EOD so the homeowner has the report in hand at dinner.

PROMPT

You are an HVAC service manager composing the same-day diagnostic report email. Below is the diagnostic. Generate a 250-word email that: (1) opens by naming the symptom the homeowner called about (no heat, no cool, strange noise, etc.); (2) names the single cause found in plain English, never a code -- "the inducer motor is no longer spinning up reliably," not "fault 33"; (3) lists the three options the homeowner has today (the minimum repair, the recommended repair, the "while we are in there" add-on), with a one-line scope and price for each; (4) closes with one yes/no question about whether they want to schedule the recommended-repair visit this week. Tone: clear, calm, no exclamation points, no filler. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER NAME]. Symptom: [SYMPTOM]. Cause: [CAUSE]. Fix: [FIX].

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 250-word client-facing diagnostic report with symptom, cause, three options, and one yes/no closing question.

Step time estimate: 12 minutes



WORKFLOW 03 OF 05

Warranty Follow-Up -- The 30-Day Check-In

A two-touch warranty follow-up that catches a callback issue within 30 days while the repair is still in warranty.

Estimated time-to-run: 5 minutes per follow-up

1*ChatGPT or Claude*

HOW TO INPUT

1. Open the prompt at day 30 after the repair closed.
2. Paste the repair type and one detail the homeowner will remember.
3. Replace the placeholders.
4. Send the email the same day.

PROMPT

You are an HVAC service manager running the 30-day warranty check-in. Below is the original repair. Generate a 150-word email that: (1) opens by naming the [REPAIR TYPE] and the date it was completed; (2) names the 3 things the homeowner should give a quick visual check (no unusual sound, no moisture, no error code on the thermostat -- whichever fits); (3) closes with one yes/no question about whether they want the tech to swing by for the 30-day check. Tone: warm, no exclamation points. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER NAME]. Repair: [REPAIR TYPE]. Detail: [DETAIL].

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 150-word warranty check-in email with 3 visual-check items and one yes/no closing question.

Step time estimate: 5 minutes



WORKFLOW 04 OF 05

Review Request -- The 14-Day Asker

A two-touch review request that lands 14 days after a completed repair. Day 14 text, Day 21 email only if missed.

Estimated time-to-run: 6 minutes per request

1*ChatGPT or Claude*

HOW TO INPUT

1. Open the prompt 14 days after the repair closed.
2. Paste the tech name and a one-sentence repair detail.
3. Replace the placeholders.
4. Send the text that morning.

PROMPT

You are an HVAC service manager running the 14-day review ask. Generate a 3-sentence SMS under 160 characters for the homeowner below. Sentence 1: thanks for the visit 14 days ago. Sentence 2: short ask for a 3-line Google review that mentions [TECH NAME] and the one specific repair detail (a capacitor swap, a thermostat install, a condensate line clear). Sentence 3: link the Google Business profile short-URL. No exclamation points, no urgency. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER FIRST NAME]. Tech: [TECH NAME]. Repair: [REPAIR DETAIL]. Short URL: [GMB SHORT URL].

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 160-character review-request SMS with one ask and a short URL.

Step time estimate: 3 minutes



WORKFLOW 05 OF 05

Off-Season Stay-Warm Plan -- The Annual Tune-Up Pitch

A quarterly off-season email plan that keeps the HVAC shop top of mind with past clients during the slow season (spring, fall). Each email has a season-specific home comfort tip and one low-pressure call to action.

Estimated time-to-run: 20 minutes to set up; runs quarterly

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ChatGPT or Claude

HOW TO INPUT

1. Open the prompt at the start of the slow season.
2. Paste the past-client list (1-3 detail lines per client).
3. Replace the placeholders.
4. Queue the 4 emails in your CRM as a quarterly stay-warm sequence.

PROMPT

You are an HVAC service manager running the off-season stay-warm plan for [QUARTER]. Below is the past-client list. Generate the 4-email quarterly sequence as a 4-row table (Client | Email Subject | Email Body -- 1 sentence teaser). Each email: (1) opens with a [QUARTER]-specific home comfort tip that is short and useful (a filter swap reminder, a thermostat battery swap, a vent-clear tip -- whichever fits); (2) names one specific scope the shop actually did for this client (a system replacement, a coil clean, a thermostat install) -- use the detail from the list; (3) closes with one yes/no question about whether they want a 15-minute check on that scope. Tone: warm, no urgency, no exclamation points. Past-client list: [PASTE].

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 4-row quarterly stay-warm table with past clients, subjects, and teasers tied to original service scope.

Step time estimate: 20 minutes